

UNIT 1 / Your first conversations

Your first conversation

Your goal: Combine greetings, introductions and requests for help.

01 Learn the idea

A successful first conversation can be very short: greet, give your name, say your country and ask one question. Use *du* for a familiar person and *Sie* for a polite interaction; avoid switching randomly between them. *Und du?* or *Und Sie?* returns a question without repeating the full sentence.

When you do not understand, say *Ich verstehe nicht* or ask *Noch einmal, bitte*. These are useful communication tools, not signs of failure. Add *Bitte langsam* when someone speaks quickly. In the dialogue, notice that the learner uses a request for repetition and then continues the conversation.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich lerne Deutsch.	I am learning German.
Ich verstehe nicht.	I do not understand.
Bitte langsam.	Slowly, please.
Und du?	And you? (informal)
Vielen Dank!	Thank you very much!

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Ben

Hallo, ich bin Ben. Wie heißt du?

Hello, I am Ben. What is your name?

Alex

Noch einmal, bitte. Ich lerne Deutsch.

Once again, please. I am learning German.

Ben

Wie heißt du?

What is your name?

Alex

Ich heiße Alex. Freut mich!

My name is Alex. Nice to meet you!

Your real-life mission

Role-play meeting a classmate. Include a greeting, your name, your country, one question and one request for repetition. Perform both roles.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich lerne Deutsch.” mean?

- A. I do not understand.
- B. I am learning German.
- C. Slowly, please.

2. What does “Ich verstehe nicht.” mean?

- A. Slowly, please.
- B. And you? (informal)
- C. I do not understand.

3. What does “Bitte langsam.” mean?

- A. Slowly, please.
- B. And you? (informal)
- C. Thank you very much!

4. Which phrase politely asks someone to repeat?

- A. Auf Wiedersehen!
- B. Noch einmal, bitte.
- C. Ich heie Ben.

5. Why does Alex ask for repetition?

- A. Alex is learning German
- B. Alex is leaving
- C. Alex wants coffee

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. B - I am learning German.

“Ich lerne Deutsch.” means “I am learning German.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. C - I do not understand.

“Ich verstehe nicht.” means “I do not understand.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. A - Slowly, please.

“Bitte langsam.” means “Slowly, please.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - Noch einmal, bitte.

Noch einmal means once again; bitte makes it a polite request.

5. A - Alex is learning German

Alex explains Ich lerne Deutsch immediately after asking for repetition.

One possible mission response

Hallo! Ich heiße Alex. Ich komme aus Indien. Und du? Noch einmal, bitte. Vielen Dank!

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

Open your interactive course at <https://everygyan.com/learn-german>. Free additional A1 practice: <https://www.goethe.de/prj/dfd/en/home.cfm>

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